



Ask ONE

# Answers from trusted ONE guidance

Help customers find useful answers and reach the right service.

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Proposal for one month of discovery

# Finding guidance should lead to a clear next step

We want to test whether customers can reach useful ONE guidance more easily by asking a question.

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## The journey to investigate

**“Which guide applies to my question?”**

A customer may need to search several pages, interpret the guidance and decide which service to use next.

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## The experience we propose

**An answer, its source and a useful next step**

Ask ONE would explain approved guidance and link to the relevant ONE service when the task needs more information.

Discovery will test this opportunity against existing search and help journeys. ONE customer demand and benefits are still unmeasured.

# A useful answer with a source the customer can open

## Ask ONE

Illustrative example

**Where can I find shipping instructions guidance?**

Open the Shipping Instructions guide for the submission steps. For details about your own shipment, continue in ONE eCommerce.

### EXAMPLE SOURCE

#### Shipping Instructions guide

The answer would link to the supporting section.

**Open guide**

**ONE eCommerce**

## Explain the guidance

Use approved public content to answer the question in plain English.

## Make the source visible

Let the customer check the guidance and read further.

## Point to the next action

Refer to an existing service for shipment-specific tasks.

Illustrative wording and source label. This is not verified shipping advice or a live Ask ONE service.

# Ask Maersk offers a pattern worth testing for ONE

Personal research from August 2026 provides examples of the experience. It does not establish ONE customer demand.

## What the recordings show

Answers explain shipping topics and surface related content.

A schedule-related response refers customers to official tools or local offices.

Some recorded turns are incomplete.

## What ONE still needs to prove

Can approved ONE content support accurate, useful answers?

Do service links help customers complete their next step?

Does the proposed experience work reliably on representative ONE questions?

The benchmark informs our design questions. It does not prove answer correctness, production reliability or a business return.

# One month of discovery defines a testable first release

## What discovery will produce

### 01 A priority customer journey

Questions to test and a comparison with existing help.

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### 02 A permitted content sample

Sources, owners and gaps that affect useful answers.

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### 03 A bounded proof of concept

Initial scope, evaluation criteria, risks and the next decision.

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## First MVP boundary

**English only**

**Public ONE content**

**One question at a time**

No sign-in is needed. Answers show sources and relevant service links.

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**Later work:** more languages, customer-account data, transactions, conversation and complex integrations.

MVP means minimum viable product. A proof of concept (PoC) tests feasibility before committing to the build.

# A rough nine-month path from discovery to stabilization

Subject to change after the PoC. Months run from discovery kickoff and assume timely decisions between stages.

| Period     | Focus                     | Proposed milestone                                      |
|------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Month 1    | Discovery                 | Initial scope, permitted sample and PoC proposal        |
| Month 2    | Bounded PoC               | Reassess scope, costs and the remaining schedule        |
| Months 3–4 | Core development          | Working preview in Month 4                              |
| Months 5–6 | Hardening                 | Manager demo in Month 6                                 |
| Month 7    | Limited user pilot        | Evidence from a controlled audience and content set     |
| Month 8    | Target production release | Controlled rollout if readiness criteria pass           |
| Month 9    | Stabilization             | Monitor use, fix priority issues and improve operations |

Evaluation and security start during discovery and the PoC, then continue throughout development.

# Content readiness can significantly move the schedule

PO/PPO and content owners need to agree which guidance is useful, resolve gaps and approve it for the intended audience.

## Before the PoC

A representative sample with permission for testing must be available.

## Before the pilot

The minimum useful content set must be approved and current.

## If sources are late

Consider fewer approved topics. If the minimum set is missing, revise the dates.

## Separate readiness reviews

**Before the Month 7 pilot:** review test evidence, approved sources, monitoring and safe fallback.

**Before the Month 8 release:** confirm pilot results, content readiness and operational support.

The manager demo is a progress milestone. Release depends on quality, security and reliability evidence.

Missed criteria require a revised forecast, which may extend beyond Month 9. Stabilization still follows the actual release.

# Potential extensions after the first release

|                                    |                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>More languages</b>              | Ask questions and receive guidance in additional languages.                     |
| <b>eCommerce integrations</b>      | Retrieve current schedules or shipment information through authorized services. |
| <b>Signed-in customer features</b> | See information relevant to the customer's account and permitted shipments.     |
| <b>Follow-up questions</b>         | Clarify a question and continue the same task without starting again.           |
| <b>Connected customer support</b>  | Share an unresolved question and relevant context with support, with consent.   |

These options sit outside the nine-month estimate. Priorities and dates depend on customer demand, feasibility and separate approval.

# The investment decision needs evidence of customer value

Compare Ask ONE with existing search and help on the same representative questions.

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## Useful guidance

**Did the customer find a supported answer and the right next step?**

Review answer correctness, successful guidance and the usefulness of service links.

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## Less effort

**Did the customer reach useful guidance more easily?**

Measure time to an answer, task completion and user feedback.

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## Viable operating cost

**Is the improvement worth the cost of providing it?**

Estimate cost per successful answer and ongoing content maintenance.

Discovery defines the comparison. The PoC supplies initial evidence. A later pilot tests real use before a wider investment decision.

Benefits remain hypotheses. No savings, ROI or product-performance results are claimed.

# Approval to begin one month of discovery

We request approval to investigate the customer journey and content, then return with a bounded proof-of-concept proposal.

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- 01 Agree the first customer journey and a review at the end of the month.
  - 02 Confirm the minimum content needs and obtain a permitted sample for testing.
  - 03 Return with an initial MVP scope, evaluation approach, feasibility questions and a recommendation.
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The next decision is whether to proceed with the PoC, revise the approach or stop.

## TECHNICAL FOCUS

# How the proposed service would work

Architecture, source management, security and evaluation provide the evidence behind the delivery decision.

The following designs are proposals to validate during the PoC and later readiness testing.

# Retrieve approved guidance, then compose a checked answer

Use the proposed Google Cloud platform direction while keeping source selection and response controls in the application.



## Application on GKE

Google Kubernetes Engine hosts the web experience and APIs that enforce request and source rules.



## Retrieve source passages

Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) supplies relevant approved content. Cloud SQL with pgvector is an initial option.



## Gemini through Vertex AI

Managed inference composes the answer. The application checks source support and citations before returning it.

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## What the PoC must establish

Can this approach retrieve the right passages and produce useful answers within an acceptable response time and cost? Compare it with ordinary search before fixing component choices.

Cloudflare remains the proposed edge. Cloud Storage keeps source versions. Live customer-data APIs are future options.

# Every answer needs a source that can be updated or removed

Retain the source link, owner and version through extraction and retrieval so content changes can reach the answer service.

| Stage               | Proposed behavior                                                              | Evidence to collect in the PoC                                       |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Collect and approve | Use permitted English public content. Keep drafts and restricted material out. | Can the sample support the chosen customer questions?                |
| Prepare and index   | Extract useful passages with source IDs, versions and links.                   | Do tables, attachments and duplicates affect retrieval or citations? |
| Review and publish  | Evaluate candidate content and record approval before release.                 | Can a reviewed version reproduce the expected answers?               |
| Update and remove   | Synchronize Drupal changes and retire obsolete index and cache entries.        | Does a changed or removed source stop serving stale guidance?        |

The PoC tests a sample lifecycle. Production work must validate synchronization at scale, recovery and ongoing maintenance.

# Content review needs a small, traceable workflow

Assess existing tools first. A custom Hub is justified only if the required workflow cannot be met adequately.

## Illustrative review queue

| Source                      | Status            | Next action         |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
| Shipping Instructions guide | Update staged     | Review the changes  |
| Older guidance version      | Removal requested | Retire from answers |
| Current public guide        | Approved          | View review history |

Example entries show a proposed workflow, not live records.

## Minimum capability

See source status and approval.

Handle updates and removals.

Keep review and release history.

## PoC question

Can existing tools support this workflow and demonstrate traceable changes to the answer service?

# The application controls what can enter an answer

Public access still needs source restrictions, protected administration and controls against unsafe inputs and outputs.

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## Before retrieval

Validate the request, enforce limits and select only approved public sources.

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## During generation

Treat retrieved text as untrusted input. Keep restricted content outside the model context.

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## Before the response

Check citations and source support, apply output screening and fall back to permitted guidance or support.

## Test from the PoC onward

Try restricted documents, malicious instructions, unsupported answers and screening failures.

Model Armor is a candidate input/output screening layer. Test false positives and response-time impact.

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Later readiness testing must validate access enforcement, privacy handling and recovery under load.

# Test the evidence, the answer and the customer's next step

## One reviewed test case

**"Where can I find shipping instructions guidance?"**

### Expected source

The current approved guide and a working citation.

### Expected answer

Explain only what the source supports and link to the relevant next step.

### Failure examples

An invented deadline, a broken citation or a restricted passage.

## Build evidence from the start

Define questions and initial acceptance criteria during discovery. Refine them with PoC findings.

Combine deterministic source/access checks, automated answer evaluation and human judgment.

Ragas and Vertex AI Evaluation are options to assess. Human review checks whether guidance is actually correct and useful.

PoC: compare results with search. Before formal testing: agree thresholds. Pilot: validate outcomes on a defined audience and workload.

# Each request should leave useful evidence for improvement

Record enough context to locate a failure, measure the cost and compare a change with the previous version.

| Observe                                          | Control                                                   | Validate                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Response time, errors and completion             | Timeouts, bounded retries and fallback                    | PoC behavior under failure; later load and recovery tests        |
| Model, retrieval, screening and evaluation usage | Token limits, quotas and source-version-aware caching     | Cost per successful answer on an agreed workload                 |
| Source versions, citations and review outcomes   | Trace IDs, redaction, retention and restricted log access | Can a reported issue be traced without excessive sensitive data? |

## Controlled improvement

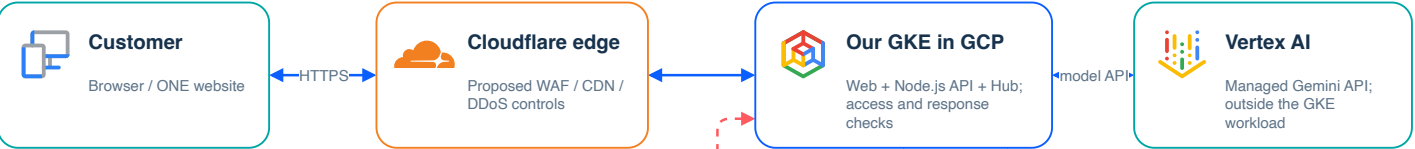
Review feedback, approve a source or application change, repeat the evaluation and compare results. Keep rollback ready. Production monitoring and support readiness remain release conditions.

# Platform architecture

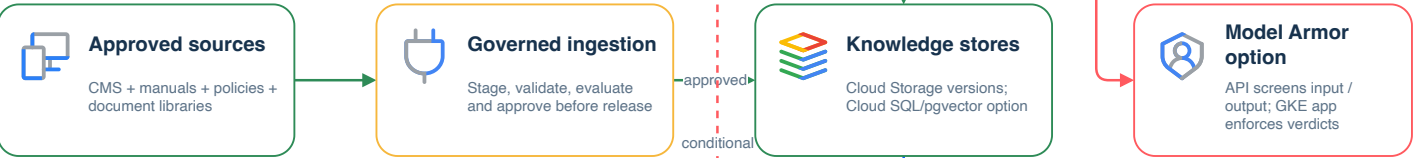
## Ask ONE on our GKE · managed AI through Vertex AI

Proposed delivery design · Phase 1 defines requirements, capacity, access and cost before any build decision

CUSTOMER REQUEST / CHECKED RESPONSE



GOVERNED KNOWLEDGE · PROPOSED STORAGE AND SCREENING OPTIONS



CONDITIONAL LIVE LOOKUPS · OPERATING CONTROLS



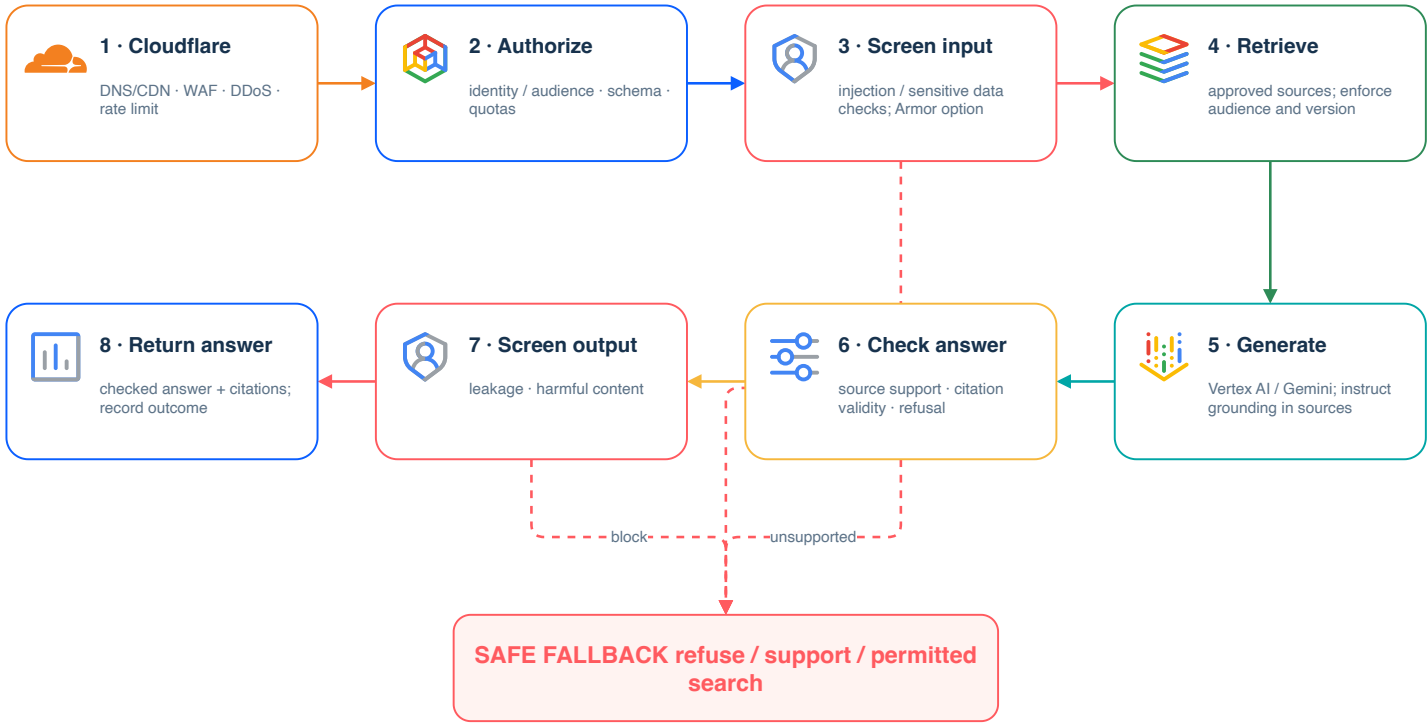
Observability correlates application, retrieval, model and security events across the service.

Proposed components require PoC validation. Conditional live APIs are future options. See Platform direction for the first-release boundary.

# Security flow

## Proposed security flow · enforce controls in the application

Any failed policy check stops the answer; fallback preserves access restrictions. Monitoring covers every stage.



Across all stages: redacted traces, denied access, suspicious activity and alerts to incident owners.

Test enforcement and failure paths during the PoC. Source checks and screening complement each other. See Security controls for the validation approach.

Use the PoC to test a sample update and removal. Production lifecycle automation needs later validation. See Knowledge source lifecycle and Evaluation approach.

